Ellen Lo

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EXPERIENCE

Lead Game Developer, Dream Park Immersive, Remote — Sep '25 - Present

- Supervised 4 external contractor teams on concurrent game projects — advised on XR game feel and user experience, guided content creation standards, troubleshot Unity and SDK integration issues, and managed deliverables against timelines
- Owned the full asset integration pipeline across 2 shipped AR titles — Crash Course and Wizard's Way — sourcing, importing, and assembling 2D and 3D assets into Unity
- Created interactive content and choreographed animation sequences by rigging models, configuring joints and leveraging assets with code, physics, shaders, VFX and animations
- Defined core punishment mechanics across all titles, authoring shaders that simulate lava damage and broken screen effects on the HUD via camera texture displacement
- Accelerated production by developing internal tools and integrating AI across the pipeline

Gameplay Programmer II, Mystic Interactive, Remote — Feb '25 - Aug '25

- Built gameplay systems with Unity C# for multiplayer VR MOBA game Crystal Conquest
- Shipped a full suite of networked power-up items (wearable rings, upgrade books, potions, and teleportation scrolls) with custom VFX and behaviors, synchronizing item states across clients via RPC events using Photon Fusion 2
- Resolved performance bottlenecks for Meta Quest standalone release, optimizing texture import pipelines and authoring custom LODs across all in-world objects
- Wrote design documents for tutorial and game economy systems and architected both from scratch, demystifying complex mechanics and creating player progression loop
- Designed UI mockups in Figma and implemented them in Unity for the in-game shop and upgrade system, rendering dynamic interfaces in 3D space with state-driven transitions

R&D Engineer, The New York Times, New York, NY — Jul '20 - Sep '22

- Led development of NYT's first mobile AR games: Shattered Crosswords and Wireloop
- Conceptualized and implemented innovative game mechanics for the Wireloop series, garnering more than 1.8M views and 30K captures on the Times' Instagram
- Collaborated with Meta and multidisciplinary teams from the NYT Graphics and Games departments to drive the production of multiple spatial stories from ideation to finish
- Wrote performant JavaScript code to solve for 3D game math and contributed reusable AR interaction components to internal library, speeding up development of 30+ effects

PROJECTS

BUGSKILL

- Solo-developed and launched casual XR game on Quest store where players swat bugs
- Developed scripts with Interaction SDK for hand swatting mechanics and power-ups

Kapu's Playground

- Crafted a playground-themed online shop with generative design, canvas, and p5.js
- Implemented front-end with React and Typescript and back-end with GraphQL via Shopify

AR Scavenger Hunt *with Two Bit Circus*

- Created a scavenger hunt localized to 15,000 sq ft space in Quest 3 Passthrough
- Adapted gameplay with Normcore Realtime API to enable multiplayer capabilities

EDUCATION

Learning Sabbatical, Los Angeles, CA — Jan '23 - Jan '25

- Pivoted into game and XR development through freelance projects, XR Prototyping Bootcamp, and a programming retreat at Recurse Center

B.S. in Computer Engineering, Boston University, Boston, MA — 2015 - 19

- Primary focus: C/C++, computer graphics, computer vision, IoT, and embedded systems